

has severely affected the team since there's no continuity.

Pakistan's coaching staff has seen frequent changes. How much has that affected team performance?

Certainly, it has had a big impact. Some coaches signed up on the condition of coming to Pakistan only during the matches, but this is not how coaching is done. A coach needs to be in Pakistan, be with the players, and plan things out — in terms of the pitches, the players — but if a coach isn't present, then obviously things won't work.

For instance, Jason Gillespie did push the team, but that wasn't enough. I think we need to mix and match. If we hire an overseas coach, then we need to ensure that the crux of the staff remains local to take

care of things. Look at India — most of its support staff is local, barring a couple of them. We need to follow that system.

I was a spin-bowling coach a few months ago, but now I am not there. Someone is there today, and tomorrow he may be replaced with someone else, so this constant chopping and changing has been a huge problem.

Aaqib Javed has been involved with the team in various roles for a long time. Despite that, the team has struggled. Why?

In the ODI format, you have to play a little positively since it is longer than T20s. Saim Ayub was our opener, and his absence was a big blow. I don't know what they did with Imam-ul-Haq. He's a good

player, who maintained a consistent average of 45 as an opener, so how can you keep him out as an opener? That's not all. First, you drop him, and then you call him back — that's not fair on the player because his confidence takes a beating. He constantly fears that he may be dropped again, so that was a major problem.

Then, we forced Babar Azam to become an opener. So, there are problems, and if you want to build a team for the future, you can't make 50 changes in a year. You have to minimise your changes and create a bench. You have to give time to the players, irrespective of their form. Look at the way India backed Virat Kohli. His bad patch continued for long, but no one forced him to quit, while Babar, one of Pakistan cricket's biggest stars, is going through a lull, and everyone is busy pulling him down.

You have only one star, and if you degrade him too, then how will your cricket survive? These are big issues. Our former cricketers should keep their mouths shut.

Pakistan dropped Babar and Rizwan from T20Is but retained them for ODIs. Does this selection policy make sense?

Does this selection policy make sense?

(Laughs) Mark my words, they will bring them back into the T20I team. If you want to send a clear message to Babar and Rizwan that they won't be considered going forward, that's one thing.

But you have dropped them from T20Is while keeping them for ODIs. So, what happens if they score runs in ODIs against New Zealand? You

GETTY IMAGES

YOU HAVE TO GIVE TIME TO THE PLAYERS, IRRESPECTIVE OF THEIR FORM. LOOK AT HOW INDIA BACKED VIRAT KOHLI. HIS BAD PATCH CONTINUED FOR LONG, BUT NO ONE FORCED HIM TO QUIT